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Oral-Argument Calendar Notice

United States Court of Appeals for the Fourth Circuit United States v. Mateo Serrano
Appeal No. SYN-CA4-26-CR-4201 Document 34 Filed June 10, 2026

The clerk places this appeal on the fictional oral-argument calendar for Tuesday, July 7, 2026. The exercise panel consists of Judge Slate, presiding, Judge Alder, and Judge March. The assignment is final for this training sitting unless the clerk issues a public amendment.

Argument will address the allocution issue preserved by the court's May 5 target-limited order. Counsel should be prepared to discuss the express reservation in the plea agreement, Rule 32's personal-address requirement, plain-error prejudice, and the permissible scope of a resentencing remedy. The enhancement target is not before the panel on its merits.

The sitting occurs through the closed fictional exercise forum. No real courthouse room, videoconference link, telephone number, credential, or public-stream address is associated with this notice. Attendance directions are distributed only inside the exercise. Celia Arden will argue for Mateo Serrano, and Bram Ives will argue for the fictional United States.

Argument Administration

Each side is allotted twenty minutes. Appellant may reserve up to five minutes for rebuttal by advising the exercise clerk before argument begins. Time used for questions counts against the allotment. The presiding judge may adjust the sequence to ensure both sides can address the decisive points.

Counsel must rely on the certified record and authorities properly presented. Public discussion should use the public briefs, transcript, judgment, and docket surrogates. If a question requires protected presentence context, counsel should identify the corresponding stable subject without reciting a physical sealed-page location or disclosing personal detail in the public portion of the exercise.

The court may review the protected twins under the continued lower-record seal and the April 1 motion-and-certificate procedure. That judicial access does not change the public projection or authorize redistribution. Counsel shall avoid descriptions of any real individual, filing system, probation source, or offense mechanism. All facts and identities remain synthetic.

Issues and Filing Directions

The panel expects focused treatment of whether the absence of any personal invitation constitutes complete denial rather than limited allocution; whether the 36-month term and protected mitigation establish a possibility of a lower sentence; and whether full resentencing follows if plain error is corrected. Counsel should distinguish waiver scope from error preservation.

No supplemental brief is authorized by this notice. A party seeking to bring a new authority to the court's attention must use the applicable public procedure and avoid adding facts. Any filing involving protected content remains subject to the existing paired-filing authorization and disclosure-specific access boundary.

The clerk will record the argument as held only after the scheduled date. This notice predicts no vote, opinion, judgment, or mandate. Questions about the fictional calendar may be directed to Maela Cross through the closed exercise channel, which conveys no real contact details or court-system access.

Issued June 10, 2026.

Maela Cross Fictional Fourth Circuit Exercise Clerk